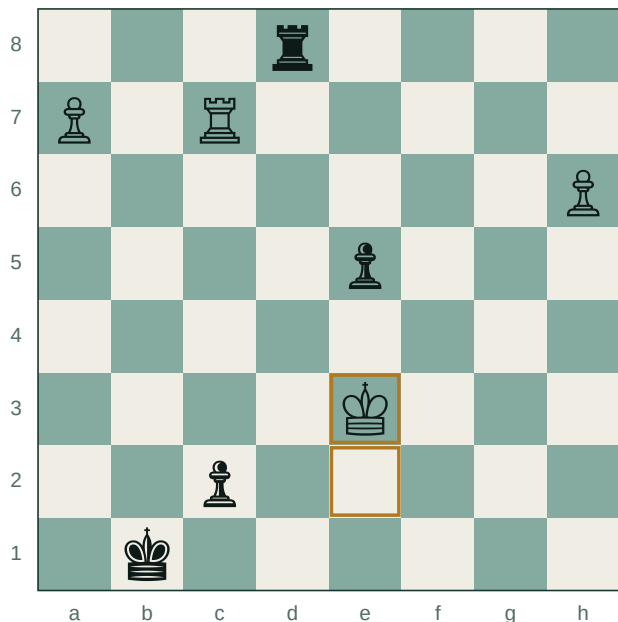


Active defensive resources: Black, move 55

Active defensive resources

Black to move



Previous move: 55.Kxe3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

55...c1=Q+ 56. Rxc1+ Kxc1 57. Ke4 Re8

55...c1=Q+ Check restricts White to 5 legal replies here. The pawn becomes a queen. From c1 it attacks king on e3 and rook on c7. Recorded reply: **56.Rxc1+**.

56...Kxc1 The king captures the rook on c1. Recorded reply: **57.Ke4**.

57...Re8 The rook moves from d8 to e8.

At the end, nominal material is White 2 / Black 6 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +4: the balance goes from +0 to +4. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A defensive puzzle may aim to preserve equality rather than win. Judge success against the threat, not only the final material count.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

The best defense may create a threat, exchange an attacker, or change the geometry of the attack. Identify the opponent's concrete idea before selecting a response.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the threatened move and the conditions it requires. Look for a move that breaks one of those conditions with tempo.

The defending king is on e3. Geometrically undefended: rook on c7. Check for tactical protection.